

Muncie Redevelopment Commission Meeting August 21st 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PtGQd1eRG6w
Publication Date	2025-08-22T01:45:00Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Report: Muny Redevelopment Commission

Meeting Date: August 21, 2025

Document Type: Comprehensive Meeting Summary & Analysis

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** President Miller called the August 21, 2025 meeting of the Muny Redevelopment Commission (MRC) to order at **00:00:20**.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Bishop, Mr. Dale, Mr. Miller (President), Miss Waggley, and Mr. Low.
 - **Absent:** Mr. Pavilla and Mr. How (noted as absent due to a family emergency).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Miller (President).

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Agenda Amendment:** President Miller moved to remove the financial and city updates (items one and two under item six) normally presented by Jeff, while keeping property

transfers for discussion. Approved by Voice Vote 00:00:49.

- **Approval of Prior Meeting Memoranda:**

- Mr. Dale moved to amend the previous meeting minutes to indicate his presence and add five detailed corrections (clarifying ownership of 620 North Walnut Street by the Greater Muny Economic Development Corporation rather than MRC, noting skate park financial satisfaction, noting Tilpond project contract updates, correcting "facade grant" spelling, and adding missing public comments by Ms. Charlie's Jameson and various commissioner comments).
- Following a second and discussion, the motion to amend the minutes passed 3-1, with Miss Waggley voting "no" 00:01:24.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:04:58 Claims Review

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Wright.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Wright presented a brief list of claims, highlighting bank fees for the 2019b Canal District Acute bond and a payment to Flat Land for concrete work and staking at gateway park.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:05:41.

00:06:06 Facade Grant Program Status Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Zayn / Mr. Bishop.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Zayn provided an update on the live facade grant program. Details include tiered eligibility (downtown properties qualify for more restoration expenses; general city limits cover scoping, demolition, and high-level renovation). Information, maps, and applications are available on the MRC webpage. The city plans to issue formal releases on Facebook and in the local journal.

00:08:26 Property Transfers: Muny Land Bank

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** President Miller / Nate Howard (Muny Land Bank).
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board considered twelve standard property transfers to the Muny Land Bank (vacant lots primarily in the Industry neighborhood to support neighborhood association work and a third-year urban planning studio partnership): 1019 East Kirby, 1111 East 5th, 1220 East Memorial, 1222 East Memorial, 1520 East Kirby, 2007 East Willard, 609 South Brady, 717 South Vine, 721 South Beacon, 805 East Willard, 806 East Willard, and 8/19 East Seymour. Mr. Howard noted final acceptance is contingent on Land Bank board approval in September.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Mr. Howard confirmed the parcels are vacant lots intended for residential/neighborhood development in partnership with the Industry neighborhood.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (contingent upon Land Bank acceptance and clean title verification) [00:13:02](#).

[00:13:13](#) **Property Transfers / Acquisition: GMED (North Coulson & East Washington)**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** President Miller / Mr. Frank / Board Members.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - *1700 Block of North Coulson:* Discussed transferring to Greater Muny Economic Development Corporation (GMED) for potential cell tower development to increase local service. Mr. Frank noted the property was recently transferred from the city to MRC and must be advertised first; therefore, the board must first pass a resolution accepting ownership. Approved by Voice Vote to accept ownership from the city [00:15:56](#).
 - *300<U+2013>312 East Washington Street (Jury Lots):* Intended for arts district housing development in partnership with GMED, MRC, and the City Arts Council. Concerns regarding lack of specific design overviews, appraisals, and legal requirements prompted a motion to table.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - North Coulson acceptance: Approved by Voice Vote [00:15:56](#).
 - 300<U+2013>312 East Washington Street: Tabled for more information by Voice Vote [00:18:56](#).

[00:19:43](#) **Updated Central Corridor Plan**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Bishop / President Miller.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Bishop volunteered edits to the updated central corridor plan (fixing boundaries, house labels, and requesting source citations for graphics). Mr. Dale strongly criticized the document, stating it fails IRS low-income housing tax credit requirements, lacks community engagement and specificity, and omits the project DM plan.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved as is, contingent on adding missing citations, passed 3-1 (Mr. Dale voted "no") [00:22:10](#).

[00:24:24](#) **Funding Request: Light Up My Town Event**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Amber Green (City Communications Director).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Ms. Green requested \$10,000 from MRC general funds to support the annual event (formerly Light Up Downtown/Christmas tree lighting), which will now be put on directly by the city and feature a new "lit parade" at Canon Commons alongside traditional first Thursday in December activities.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:27:40](#).

[00:28:10](#) **Innovation Connector / Certified Tech Park Pass-Through Funds**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Members / Mr. Wright.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board processed the annual state pass-through funds for the certified tech park via the Innovation Connector, noting that municipal redevelopment commissions act strictly as the pass-through entity.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:29:14](#).

[00:29:23](#) Muny Land Bank Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nate Howard.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Howard reported that the Land Bank sold/transferred four properties to the Ross Center, executed the first transfer of 11 properties for the Old West End development (swapping out two properties: 913 West Kilgore and 509 West Adams), and submitted an ask to the county for 45 properties (noting 60% were unavailable). Additionally, partnerships continue with the third-year planning studio for the Industry neighborhood.

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [00:34:07](#) **Rick Yenser (Newsman and Author):** Spoke in opposition to utilizing \$2 million in public funds for a proposed housing subdivision in a field near Farmington given to the city by Ball State, arguing that private developers build housing without tax dollars and public funds should not be used for residential additions.
- [00:36:43](#) **Jeff Crowder (Local Building Owner):** Noted issues regarding a recently acquired city parking lot graded into his property that is eroding his foundation, and requested access to the parking lot to repair his backyard block wall. President Miller agreed to connect with him after the meeting.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - President Miller wished Mr. How and his family well regarding a family emergency.
 - Next meeting scheduled for September 18th, 2025.
- **Adjournment:** Officially adjourned at [00:38:04](#) by Voice Vote.

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